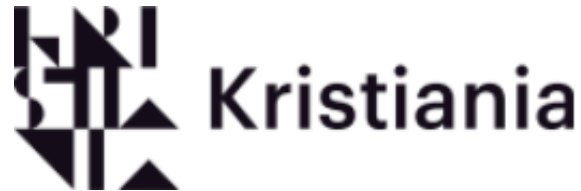


IT-Project management

BU5300 course
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Candidates: 258, 133, 220, 47, 13, 324, 256, 28
Group: 14.

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1.Executive summary

Problem:

The recent influx of AI adoption has made entry-level jobs for sectors such as IT and customer service very competitive and difficult to apply for (WEF. 2026). Existing platforms such as Linked-in and Finn.no lack targeted matching for novices, resulting in prolonged unemployment for new grads.

Proposed Solution:

Studia is an AI-powered, algorithm driven mobile app developed by NextStep that connects students and new grads with entry-level roles. It implements skill-based AI matchmaking, daily recommendations, video interview tools, and a transparent rating system for both students and employers.

Target users/Customers:

- Students and early graduates that have a hard time in today's job market
- Employers seeking junior talent.
- Employers that seek best students for their early positions
- Students that seek best jobs as a start for their career path

Value Created:

Reduces grad and student unemployment, accelerating the time from studies to first time job, builds a stronger industry relationship between early grads and employers. Later, generating scalable revenue with a return of investment positive by year 2, and reaching 1.2m - 1.4m NOK by year 3.

2. Business Case

Description of problem or opportunity

Students and new graduates are facing increased difficulty entering the job market even when they were only working in the beginner field. LinkedIn and Finn.no are more suitable for very broad audiences but are not designed to apply well to students with less or no work experience. Consequently, students do not necessarily serve the well-defined job market, creating inefficiencies for job seekers and employers.

Such work would also enable the development of a more tailored platform that connects students with relevant job opportunities and makes the transition into work easier, lowering the recruitment process of friction.

Proposed solution and why it is viable

Studia is a mobile application to help students get jobs more quickly. It makes use of intelligent matchmaking technology to match jobs based on their skills, education level, and level of interest with job opportunities.

Key features include CV support that can provide job recommendations, job categorization, interview prep tools, and a rating program as well as an experience tracking system to help keep track of profiles.

The solution is realistic because it is based on existing technologies like AI recommendation systems and mobile apps. With this process, we can make great progress first and continue to do so to check for issues and improve in a short time. Also, the project is compatible with Studia's mission of helping students get an opportunity to connect with the job market in the long term.

Expected benefits

There might be qualitative and financial benefits to the project. From a qualitative standpoint, it will enhance job opportunities for students, build connections, and strengthen and develop students' relationships with employers with more engagement by Studia and its view as a student-focused organization.

From a financial perspective, the platform can grow revenue from employer partnerships and subscription services. A revenue of NOK 0 in the first year then grows to about NOK 1.2 million by years three and four, and the platform could grow as the marketplace should. These numbers have been calculated on the fact that an extremely successful startup such as finn.no managed to pull around 25 million NOK 2-3 years after its startup in 1999 according to NRK (NRK. 2003).

Cost estimate

The project has both one-time and ongoing expenses. One-time costs involve application development, UI/UX design, legal setup, and initial marketing. Ongoing costs are hosting, maintenance, security, and customer support.

Infrastructure costs are estimated at NOK 15,000 - 85,000; this depends on how long our app remains active (Dharmwan, 2026). Further expansion of the app could even lead to larger costs in infrastructure. Development and operational costs at NOK 20,000-40,000 per month. All told,

this is a moderate initial investment with high returns and higher long-term costs that can escalate over time.

Main alternatives

There were three main alternatives considered. The first one being to do nothing, where students will continue using the same platforms.

The second is to use or enhance existing platforms like LinkedIn or Finn.no. While this would require less development, it reduces flexibility and does not suit the needs of students.

The third and final option for us is to build a new dedicated platform. This provides more control over functionality, better alignment with user needs, and better long-term benefits for Studia.

3. Project Charter

Project Charter

The objective with Studia is to develop and launch a functional minimum viable product within 8 to 12 months. Core features include student and employer profiles, AI-based job matching, job search, video interview support, and a transparent rating system. This project aims to reduce the gap between education and employment while helping employers recruit junior talent more efficiently.

Description of the scope:

We separated the scopes, based on inner-scope (student/employer focused) and outer-scope (non-IT-industries focused).

In scope:

student and employer profiles, AI-based matchmaking, job search and filtering, video interview function, rating system, CV guidance, onboarding, and GDPR compliance.

Out of scope:

international expansion, non-IT industries, and detailed sprint planning beyond initial planning level.

Success Criteria

The project will be considered successful if the app is launched within the agreed scope and timeframe, achieves at least 10000 student users and 500 employer partners within six months, reaches at least 70% satisfaction with AI matchmaking based on user feedback, and passes a GDPR compliance review before launching. We have based our success criteria expectations on the statistics of similar startups such as linked-in. Our success criteria expectations are solidified by the fact that linked-in pushed 1m users in its first 2 years (Stumbles. 2017).

Key Assumptions and Constraints

The project assumes that students and employers are willing to use a dedicated platform for juniors' recruitment, that means enough data is available for a meaningful AI recommendation, and that the team has the required technical capacity. Key constraints include limited time, budget team resources, and the requirement to comply with GDPR before launch

Team Roles and Responsibilities

Nurtaj Nabi (Project Manager):

The project manager is responsible for overall delivery, coordination, and stakeholder communication with external factors, not only internally.

Nikola Andonovic (Initiation Manager):

Initiation manager calls the final shots on large decision and prepares the project charter and defined the initial scope.

Petter Stordalen (Sponsor):

This sponsor is a part of a large network of stakeholders; he provides strategic oversight and approves major decisions.

Billal Esse (Cloud/DevOps Team Leader):

Cloud/ DevOps Team leader Is responsible for infrastructure, deployment, and system reliability.

Patrick Haugeland (Head of Marketing):

The head of marketing leads marketing and user awareness activities.

Qasid Ali Saleem (Head of Sales):

Head of sales manages employer outreach and partnerships.

Mustaf Hassan (Financial Advisor):

The financial advisor supports budgeting and cost control.

Suhan Tanatar (HR):

HR supports recruitment and internal coordination.

Developers, the Security Engineer (GDPR), and the Cloud Specialist:

They support implementation, compliance, and technical operations.

4. Project Plan

Project approach

We have chosen a hybrid approach for our project which aligns with the PRINCE2 governance combined with agile execution. This combines the structured planning, milestones, and formal change control of PRINCE2 with the flexibility of agile sprints needed for rapid AI model tuning and user feedback. The hybrid model is ideal for this AI-driven startup project where some

requirements, especially the matching algorithm, will evolve during development (Lecture 4 and slide 6).

WP ID	Work Package	Deliverables
1.0	Planning	PID, team setup
2.0	Design	UI/UX prototypes, GDPR framework
3.1	Epic 1: Job search	Search engine (US1), algorithm (US2)
3.2	Epic 2: Easier Job Access	Trending jobs, ratings
3.3	Epic 3: Matchmaking	AI categorization, profiles
4.0	Testing	Beta pilots, audits
5.0	Launch	Live app, monitoring

Milestone	Description	Deadline
M1	PID/team ready	March end
M2	Design/GDPR approved	April end
M3	Alpha testable	June end
M4	Beta/audits done	October end
M5	App live	December end

WP	Resources	Effort (p-days)	Cost (NOK)
1.0	PM/team	20	10,000
2.0	UX/Dev	70	45,000
3.1-3.3	Devs /AI (full)	360 (1-year)	180,000
4.0	QA	60	30,000
5.0	DevOps	40	20,000
Total	All	550 (1-year & 6 months)	285,000

5. Risk analysis

This Risk Register follows the Risk Management Process from Lecture 8 (slide. 15) and applies Boehm's (1991) top 10 risk item tracking checklist together with selected risk factors from Schmidt et al. (2001), as recommended in the lecture slides. Risks were identified, assessed using likelihood and impact, and assigned an appropriate response strategy: avoid, transfer, mitigate, or accept.

Technical risks

- Emerge from uncertainty to then develop and integrate complex systems into our app.
- Potential issues: model errors, limited or low-quality training data, unstable APIs, and system incompatibility.
- Impact: reduced detection accuracy and weakened overall system reliability. Boehm warns that technical weaknesses increase the chance of unsatisfactory outcomes.

Schedule risks

Schedule risks mean the project could take longer than expected. What this means for Studia is that the app has many linked features that include but are not limited to: AI job matching, onboarding, employer profiles, video interviews. That needs to be built in a short time. Delays may occur from limits in the team's capacity, changing requirements, integration issues, or third-party dependencies. Unrealistic timelines also raise the risk, so the scope needs to be kept, let set clear priorities, and milestones need to be tracked closely.

Risk ID	Risk Description (from Boehm/Schmidt check list)	Likelihood	Impact	Risk Score	Response Strategy	Mitigation Action	Owner
1	Technical difficulty in integrating the AI recommendation algorithm into the platform architecture	High	High	9	Mitigate	Start prototyping early, test the algorithm iteratively, and involve experienced AI developers from the outset.	AI/Development Team
2	Failure to comply with GDPR and data protection requirements	High	High	9	Avoid	Consult legal/GDPR advisors early and embed privacy by design across development.	Project Manager + Legal/GDPR Team
3	Cybersecurity breach leading to unauthorized access or data leakage	Medium	High	6	Mitigate	Perform regular penetration testing, encrypt sensitive data, enforce access controls, and continuously monitor vulnerabilities.	Security / DevOps Team
4	Low user adoption during the initial rollout phase	High	High	9	Mitigate	Run pilot testing with students, improve onboarding, gather user feedback early, and introduce awareness campaigns before launch.	Product Owner + UX Team
5	Delays caused by dependence on external stakeholders and third party integrations	Medium	High	6	Mitigate	Define technical requirements early, establish backup plans for integrations, and maintain regular coordination with external providers.	Project Manager and Integration Team
6	Misalignment between system requirements and end-user expectations	Medium	Medium	5	Mitigate	Involve end users in requirement workshops, validate features through prototypes, and review requirements continuously during development.	Dev Team + End-Users

6. Stakeholder Analysis

The key stakeholders who are involved in the Studia project have several interests, due to diversity of interests. This means we must engage and communicate in a way that suits every member of the stakeholder team. That is why we aim to keep them engaged for the foreseeable future.

According to Cadle and Yeates (2008, p. 298), “Stakeholders are individuals and groups who are affected by the activities of an organization Stakeholder are.” For Studia, this includes both external and internal stakeholders. Lecture 9 explains that stakeholder analysis follows three

main steps. “Identify stakeholders,” “Analyze the influence and expectation “, and create a communication strategy for each stakeholder.

We see fit that both the sponsor and management are deemed as “manage closely” category shown in the power/interest graph (Slabá, 20154, p. 1371). They want a sustainable business, long-term value, and a return on investment. They expect regular milestone updates, alerts as early as possible on issues with scope, budget, time, and involvement in key decisions. As they are our most important players in our development with high interest and high power.

Our internal team, consisting of UX designers, developers and security engineers, cares about the project but does not have the same power in comparison to the management in major decisions. Cadle and Yeates (2008, p. 301) points out that the group deemed “High interest but low power”, are affected by the project but at the same time have little influence over its course. They therefore need regular and clear communication, handled through sprint review and a well detailed backlog, so tasks are understood throughout this group.

Students are primary the end users for our product. They want a platform that provides them with relevant jobs, presents fair recommendations, and protects their personal data in the process. When it comes to communication, that happens through the app itself. The onboarding process, help texts, job alerts and a simple in-app feedback system.

Employers need fast access to a vast network of suitable junior candidates through trustful matching and rating systems. Their engagement strategy focuses on demonstrating value early through dashboards, application summaries and easy communication tools within the platform

When it comes to regulations, it is of dire focus to implement data protection. The absence of these implementations can cause consequences on behalf of the company. This is solidified by the fact that authorities such as Datatilsynet have high authority and expect the app to comply with relevant laws and protect user data (Molléri, 2024, Lecture 9, slide 10). These elements must be implemented before launch: privacy policies, data handling records, and proof of GDPR compliance.

As Cadle and Yeates (2008, p. 300) noted on successful projects is that all stakeholder groups tend to agree on one shared goal: delivering value to the sponsor. Keeping every group aligned through structured and appropriate communication is the foundation of Studia's stakeholder management strategy.

7. Change Management Strategy

Anticipated change: Shifting AI matching requirements

As the lecture slides for this course highlight, all new information systems bring a range of changes with them, and people are the key to the success of any IS implementation (lecture 10, slide 5). For Studia, one of the most significant changes we anticipate is a shift in what students

and employers expect from the AI matching engine once they start using the app for real. What looks good on paper in the design phase may not feel useful or fair to users in practice. This could lead to requests to change how matching scores are calculated, what profile data is weighted, or how recommendations are displayed.

Why may it occur

Cadle and Yeates (2008, p. 215) list “revised user ideas of what the project should be about, perhaps triggered by discussions that have occurred during detailed requirements analysis” as one of the most common sources of change in IS projects. In Studia’s case, the AI system is inherently difficult to fully define upfront because its quality can only really be judged when real users interact with it. Feedback from beta testing is very likely to reveal gaps between what was built and what users actually find valuable.

Who is affected

The development team would feel the biggest impact, as any change to the AI logic requires backend changes, adjusting algorithms, and rerunning tests. The project manager would therefore need to reassess the timeline and budget for our development. In addition, employers and students would also be affected, because they are the ones whose experience depends on how well the matching works. As noted in Lecture 10 (slide 8), each group is affected differently, and the change management strategy must take into account.

How the project will respond

Prosci’s definition of change management, as presented in Lecture 10 (slide 9), is “The process, tools and techniques to manage the people side of change to achieve the required business results.” For Studia, this means that when a change request comes in, we do not look at the technical fix but also at how it affects the team and the users. Cadle and Yeates (2008, p 216) are clear that “there is no such thing as an insignificant change” and that every change must go through a cost, impact, and risk assessment before a decision is made.

In practice, any request for a change goes through the project manager, who assesses how it will affect time, cost, and quality. The sponsor must approve changes that affect scope or budget. Because we are using a hybrid approach combining PRINCE2's governance with agile sprints, smaller changes can be set aside for our next sprint. Larger changes will require a plan. The lecture slides also identify active and visible executive sponsorship and frequent and open communication as the “Top Contributors to Success” (Lecture 10, slide 12), both of which are built into our project governance through regular sponsor updates and sprint reviews.

8. Funding & Budget Summary

Category	Allocation (NOK)	% of Total	Key uses
Personnel	180,000	63 %	7 Students (20-30hrs/wk @ NOK 400/day avg), freelance AI/security (40 days @ NOK 1,500/day)
Development Tools	45,000	16 %	Cloud (AWS/GCP), IDE license's, AI training, datasets, Github Enterprise
GDPR/Compliance	30,000	11 %	Legal consultations, BankID integration, privacy audits
Testing & QA	15,000	5 %	Beta users incentives, penetration testing tools, analytics
Marketing & Launch	10,000	4 %	App store fees, initial student campaigns, sponsor events
Contingency	5,000	2 %	Unforeseen (max % 10 buffer activated through exception process)
Total Cost	285,000	100 %	

External support/funding may be needed because the project team consists of full-time students with limited personal capital, while the project requires specialist AI development skills, cloud infrastructure, and GDPR compliance expertise that cannot be covered internally.

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